

# Zdeněk Kasner

LLM RESEARCHER · LECTURER · CURIOUS PERSON

📍 Prague, Czechia  
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🔗 [kasnerz](https://github.com/kasnerz)



## About me

I got interested in language models before they became *large*. Then I have spent some time researching how to make them better. Now I help people to understand them and take full control of them in their AI tools and systems.

## What can I offer

I can provide help with the following:

- Consultations on local AI deployment.
- Technical workshops on open AI models.
- Popularization lectures on AI.

*I am registered as self-employed (IČO: 06845762) and can issue invoices for my services.*

## Public outreach

I run a Czech website on open AI models *Lokální.AI*. I write blog-posts, publish a newsletter, and run a community Discord server.

## Skills & Knowledge

|                  |        |     |
|------------------|--------|-----|
| Computer Science | Python | NLP |
| Machine Learning | LLMs   | AI  |

## Languages

|         |          |          |          |          |
|---------|----------|----------|----------|----------|
| Czech   | ████████ | ████████ | ████████ | ████████ |
| English | ████████ | ████████ | ████████ | ████████ |
| French  | ████████ | ████████ | ████████ | ████████ |
| Dutch   | ████████ | ████████ | ████████ | ████████ |

## WORK & RESEARCH

|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| since 10/2026           | <b>Local AI Deployment Specialist</b><br>FREELANCER, LOKÁLNÍ.AI<br>Helping institutions and bussiness run AI solutions locally using open AI models. Consulting, analysing, preparing and implementing solutions.<br>📍 CZECHIA                                                   |
| from 09/2024 to 09/2026 | <b>Postdoctoral Researcher</b><br>FACULTY OF MATHEMATICS AND PHYSICS, CHARLES UNIVERSITY<br>Research on large language models (LLMs): controllable text generation and evaluation under the ERC grant NG-NLG (Next-Generation Natural Language Generation).<br>📍 PRAGUE, CZECHIA |
| from 09/2019 to 09/2024 | <b>PhD Researcher</b><br>FACULTY OF MATHEMATICS AND PHYSICS, CHARLES UNIVERSITY<br>Research on data-to-text generation with neural language models.<br>📍 PRAGUE, CZECHIA                                                                                                         |
| from 02/2023 to 05/2023 | <b>Research Intern</b><br>MILA – QUEBEC AI INSTITUTE<br>Research on LLM agents for web navigation, advised by Siva Reddy.<br>📍 MONTRÉAL, CANADA                                                                                                                                  |
| from 01/2019 to 09/2019 | <b>Software Developer &amp; Researcher</b><br>ROBOT PERCEPTION GROUP, CIIRC CTU IN PRAGUE<br>Natural language understanding for an automated production line and a collaborative robotic workspace.<br>📍 PRAGUE, CZECHIA                                                         |
| from 06/2018 to 09/2018 | <b>Research Intern</b><br>KDDI RESEARCH, INC.<br>Developing an augmented reality annotation system.<br>📍 SAITAMA, JAPAN                                                                                                                                                          |
| from 07/2016 to 08/2017 | <b>Software Developer</b><br>AI CENTER, FEE CTU IN PRAGUE<br>Implementing a search engine with intermodal routing for public transport.<br>📍 PRAGUE, CZECHIA                                                                                                                     |
| from 04/2015 to 07/2016 | <b>Software Developer</b><br>CESNET<br>Developing a module for device classification in a high-throughput system for network traffic analysis (NEMEA).<br>📍 PRAGUE, CZECHIA                                                                                                      |

## TEACHING & LECTURING

|                   |                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| since 2026        | <b>Neural Language Models (NI-NLM)</b><br>FIT CTU<br>A new elective course from scratch: teaching lectures and labs.<br>📍 PRAGUE, CZECHIA                       |
| since 2025        | <b>Computational Creativity</b><br>DIDAKTIKON UK<br>Interactive workshop for primary and secondary schools.<br>📍 PRAGUE, CZECHIA                                |
| from 2024 to 2026 | <b>Large Language Models (NPFL140)</b><br>MFF UK<br>Assisting with lectures and assignments.<br>📍 PRAGUE, CZECHIA                                               |
| from 2023 to 2025 | <b>Introduction to Machine Learning with Python (NPFL129)</b><br>MFF UK<br>Lab teaching.<br>📍 PRAGUE, CZECHIA                                                   |
| 2022              | <b>Introduction to Linux (NSWI177)</b><br>MFF UK<br>Lab teaching (inverted class: no lectures).<br>📍 PRAGUE, CZECHIA                                            |
| 2020              | <b>Programming I (NPRG030) &amp; Introduction to Algorithms (NPRG062)</b><br>MFF UK<br>Lab teaching, preparing and evaluating assignments.<br>📍 PRAGUE, CZECHIA |

## Certificates

**Certificate of Proficiency in English (C2)**  
Cambridge Level 3 in ESOL International

## Volunteering

**Board of European Students of Technology** (2014 – 2019)  
Communication and cooperation with students of European universities of technology, organizing courses and engineering competitions.

## Organizer

- **DGT Summer School Luxembourg**, 2025  
Co-organizer, speaker
- **PracticalD2T Workshop** @ INLG 2024  
Co-organizer
- **PracticalD2T Workshop** @ INLG 2023  
Main organizer
- **SIGDIAL & INLG 2023**  
Local organizer

## Awards

- **Best short paper** at INLG 2025 (Onderková et al., 2025)
- **Joseph Fourier Prize** organized by French Embassy in Prague, 2nd place (2025)
- **Honorable mention** CU Grant Agency award (2023)
- **Outstanding reviewer** at EACL 2021
- **Best short paper** at INLG 2020 (Dušek and Kasner, 2020)

## EDUCATION

from 10/2019  
to 09/2024

### PhD in Computational Linguistics

FACULTY OF MATHEMATICS AND PHYSICS, CHARLES UNIVERSITY  PRAGUE, CZECHIA

- **Thesis:** Domain Adaptation for Natural Language Generation
- **Advisor:** Ondřej Dušek

from 07/2016  
to 06/2019

### Master in Artificial Intelligence

FACULTY OF ELECTRICAL ENGINEERING, CZECH TECHNICAL UNIVERSITY IN PRAGUE  PRAGUE, CZECHIA

- **Thesis:** Incorporating Language Models into Non-autoregressive Neural Machine Translation
- Dean award & minor degree in Computer Vision

from 09/2017  
to 02/2018

### Erasmus+

KATHOLIEKE UNIVERSITEIT LEUVEN  LEUVEN, BELGIUM

Courses from Master of AI.

from 09/2013  
to 06/2016

### Bachelor in Computer Science

FACULTY OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY, CTU IN PRAGUE  PRAGUE, CZECHIA

- **Thesis:** Flow-Based Classification of Devices in Computer Networks
- Graduated with honors

## SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

2026

Zdeněk Kasner, Vilém Zouhar, Patrícia Schmidtová, Ivan Kartáč, Kristýna Onderková, Ondřej Plátek, Dimitra Gkatzia, Saad Mahamood, Ondřej Dušek, and Simone Balloccu, "LLMs as Span Annotators: A Comparative Study of LLMs and Humans", in *Proceedings of the 2026 Workshop on Multilingual Multicultural Evaluation*, co-located with EACL 2026, 2026.

Zdeněk Kasner, and Ondřej Dušek, "AnimatedLLM: Explaining LLMs with Interactive Visualizations", in *Proceedings of 2026 TeachingNLP Workshop*, co-located with EACL 2026, 2026.

Danil Semin, Ondřej Dušek, and Zdeněk Kasner, "Strategies for Span Labeling with Large Language Models", *arXiv:2601.16946*, 2026.

2025

Kristýna Onderková, Ondřej Plátek, Zdeněk Kasner, and Ondřej Dušek, "FreshTab: Sourcing Fresh Data for Table-to-Text Generation Evaluation", in *Proceedings of the 18th International Natural Language Generation Conference*, 2025.

2024

Xing Han Lu, Zdeněk Kasner, and Siva Reddy, "WebLINX: Real-World Website Navigation with Multi-Turn Dialogue", in *Proceedings of the ICML 2024*, 2024.

Zdeněk Kasner, and Ondřej Dušek, "Beyond Traditional Benchmarks: Analyzing Behaviors of Open LLMs on Data-to-Text Generation", in *Proceedings of the ACL 2024 (Volume 1: Long Papers)*, 2024.

Zdeněk Kasner, Ondřej Plátek, Patrícia Schmidtová, Simone Balloccu, and Ondřej Dušek, "factgenie: A Framework for Span-based Evaluation of Generated Texts", in *Proceedings of the 17th International Natural Language Generation Conference (System Demonstrations)*, 2024.

2023

Zdeněk Kasner, Ekaterina Garanina, Ondřej Plátek, and Ondřej Dušek, "TabGenie: A Toolkit for Table-to-Text Generation", in *Proceedings of the ACL (Volume 3: System Demonstrations)*, 2023.

Zdeněk Kasner, Ioannis Konstas, and Ondřej Dušek, "Mind the Labels: Describing Relations in Knowledge Graphs With Pretrained Models", in *Proceedings of the EACL 2023*, 2023.

2022

Zdeněk Kasner, and Ondřej Dušek, "Neural Pipeline for Zero-Shot Data-to-Text Generation", in *Proceedings of the ACL 2022 (Volume 1: Long Papers)*, 2022.

2021

Zdeněk Kasner, Simon Mille, and Ondřej Dušek, "Text-in-Context: Token-Level Error Detection for Table-to-Text Generation", in *Proceedings of the INLG 2021*, 2021.

2020

Ondřej Dušek, and Zdeněk Kasner, "Evaluating Semantic Accuracy of Data-to-Text Generation with Natural Language Inference", in *Proceedings of the INLG 2020*, 2020.

Zdeněk Kasner, and Ondřej Dušek, "Data-to-Text Generation with Iterative Text Editing", in *Proceedings of the INLG 2020*, 2020.

Zdeněk Kasner, and Ondřej Dušek, "Train Hard, Finetune Easy: Multilingual Denoising for RDF-to-Text Generation", in *Proceedings of the INLG 2020 (WebNLG+ Workshop)*, 2020.

Zdeněk Kasner, Jindřich Libovický, and Jindřich Helcl, "Improving Fluency of Non-Autoregressive Machine Translation", *arXiv:2004.03227*, 2020.